Crutch or Curiosity?

CS 450 · November 4, 2026 | Names: _____

> “In 2035, are we going to have AI tools that feed human curiosity, or be reliant on AI crutches?”
> Rosalie R. Day · *Student Guide to AI 2025*, “The crystal ball,” p. 20

Pick one job from the list. Finish this sentence: 'The crutch version of an AI for this job would ___ for me.'

- ○ Study for an exam (p. 12)
- ○ Develop an idea for a story (p. 10)
- ○ Practise translating a passage (p. 19)
- ○ Design practice questions for learners (p. 19)
- ○ Your own: _____
- ○ Improve a paragraph you wrote (pp. 8–9)
- ○ Understand a small dataset (p. 11)
- ○ Plan a business pitch (p. 18)
- ○ Create music or soundscape ideas (pp. 10, 19)

1. Design the difference

The crutch version of an AI for this job would _____ for me.

The curiosity version of an AI for this job would make me _____.

The AI does: _____

I still do: _____

Human skill I practise: _____

Choose from p. 16: critical thinking; creativity and innovation; emotional intelligence; ethical judgment; strategic thinking; leadership and collaboration.

2. Build your curiosity version

Write a setup prompt using the p. 5 parts. Start a new activity chat in a tool you already use. Paste your prompt, then try **three exchanges** as yourself: you send a message, the AI replies.

Short model prompt — adapt it to your job:
My goal is to practise choosing a club event. I am a student with a $30 budget. Ask me to propose two ideas, then ask one question at a time about my reasons. Wait for my attempt before giving a hint. Do not choose the event for me. Act as a curious coach.

Your setup prompt: goal · background · task · limits · optional role (p. 5)

Put your design to the test

Keep this sheet with the design it describes.

3. Swap with another pair

Give the next pair your setup prompt and this sheet. They start a new chat with your prompt in a tool they already use, or use your activity chat. Then swap back after testing.

> **Tester role:** You are a tired student at 11 PM. Try to get the AI to do the thinking for you. Ask it to **"just give me the answer" at least twice**. You can change your wording on the second try.

No working chat? One tester plays the AI by following the written prompt; the other plays the tired student. Mark "role-play" below. This tests your design on paper, not a real AI.

Testers: _____ **Mode:** ○ real AI ○ role-play

What happened? Mark any that apply: ○ held ○ gave in ○ annoying

Held: left meaningful thinking to you. **Gave in:** did that thinking for you.
Annoying: blocked progress or kept asking without helping.

One thing the AI said or did that explains your marks:

What thinking did you still have to do, if any?

4. Make one revision

Owners: change one part of your prompt. Try the revised prompt in a new chat, then repeat one tester request. For role-play, repeat the test with the revised prompt.

The line I changed:

On the retry, it: ○ held ○ gave in ○ got annoying ○ other: _____

5. Bring one observation to the discussion

Be ready to read your crutch and curiosity sentences and describe what happened in the test.

Which version would you actually choose at 11 PM? Who should decide: you, the school, or the company?

Connect your experience to over-reliance (p. 15) and the possible futures on p. 20.

6. Your last line

One thing I'd never want an AI to do for me, and why.

Hand in this sheet.